    - Although not directly involved in drone construction, Nikola Tesla’s early experiments in wireless control provided the conceptual foundation for UAV communication systems. His 1898 demonstration of a radio-controlled boat proved that machines could be operated remotely using electromagnetic signals a breakthrough that inspired later innovators to apply similar principles to aircraft.
- *Reginald Denny (United States)*
    - Actor and aviator Reginald Denny played a critical role in advancing radio-controlled aircraft in the 1930s. He established the Reginald Denny Industries company, which produced the Radioplane OQ-2, the first mass-produced radio-controlled target drone used by the US Army during World War II. Denny’s efforts marked the transition from experimental prototypes to industrial-scale UAV production.
- *De Havilland and the Royal Navy (United Kingdom)*
    - The de Havilland Aircraft Company, in collaboration with the Royal Navy, developed the DH.82B “Queen Bee” (1935) a modified, radio-controlled version of the Tiger Moth biplane. It became the first truly operational UAV used for anti-aircraft gunnery training, and its success popularized the term “*drone*.” The Queen Bee demonstrated the military potential of reusable unmanned systems, solidifying UAV technology as a key research field in aviation.